

You Will . . .

- **Invest in “boring” company retirement plans—even if you think you can’t afford it.** Remember, company-sponsored retirement plans like the 401(k) are the number one way the millionaires we studied built their wealth.
- **Build your wealth slowly and steadily over time.** 79% attribute regular, consistent investing in retirement plans over a long period of time as the reason for their success.
- **Pay off your house.** It took millionaires an average of 10.2 years to pay off their homes, and 67% of them live in homes with paid-off mortgages.
- **Live intentionally by budgeting and avoiding debt.** Remember, 93% of the millionaires we studied say they stick to the budgets they create, and 96% of millionaires never carry a balance on a credit card.
- **Go to (or send your kids to) college—probably state schools—without any student loan debt.** A total of 79% of millionaires did not attend prestigious private schools: 62% of millionaires graduated from public state schools, 8% attended community college, and 9% never graduated college at all. Also, 68% of the millionaires with a college degree never took out a penny in student loans.
- **Take responsibility for yourself.** 97% of millionaires say, “I control my own destiny.”
- **Set—and achieve—goals for yourself.** An overwhelming majority (97%) of millionaires say they almost always achieve the goals they set for themselves.
- **Work hard. Really hard.** 93% of millionaires said they got there by hard work rather than big salaries.